Paying will get further faster than learning on your own

Channel: Tim Luong · Published: Oct 28, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/YQ_WRje6kvM Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Tim Luong failed three businesses at UC before scaling his fourth to $1M in year one by paying a mentor who had already solved the same problems — he argues buying access to proven experience beats a decade of solo trial and error.

📑 Contents

- 🏫 Three Failures at University and the Turning Point
- 💡 The Core Insight: Paying for Shortcuts
- 🔄 An Ongoing Personal Strategy

🏫 Three Failures at University and the Turning Point 0:00

- Tim failed at **three separate business ventures** while studying at the University of California
- His fourth business was the first to succeed — and it reached **$1 million in its first year**
- He attributes most of that success to one specific decision:
  - Paying someone who already knew how to scale his exact business model
  - That person had deep familiarity with the model's inner workings
  - Crucially, they had *already done it before* — not just in theory
  - Tim joined that person's group and educational programs
  - He then copied and executed everything they said, word for word

💡 The Core Insight: Paying for Shortcuts 0:23

- Tim's realization: **there are real shortcuts in business and wealth-building** when you follow the right person
- What makes a mentor valuable in this model:
  - They have spent years making the mistakes you would otherwise have to make yourself
  - They have lost money discovering what doesn't work
  - They have already found the solutions
- The payoff for the learner:
  - You compress years of painful trial and error into a much shorter timeline

- You avoid spending an entire decade learning lessons the hard way

> "There are real shortcuts in business and wealth when you follow someone who spent years making those mistakes, losing money, and discovering the solutions."

🔄 An Ongoing Personal Strategy 0:45

- Tim still applies this approach today — it is not a one-time tactic but a continuous practice
- His repeatable framework:
  - Identify someone who is ahead of him and knows how to reach where he wants to go
  - Find a way to pay for access or participation in their community or program
  - Use that access to avoid making costly mistakes alone
- The underlying philosophy: the cost of paying a mentor is almost always less than the cost (in time and money) of figuring it out independently